

are uniquely transmitting their own individual codes.. When an stylus is brought close to the structure the unique code is read and thus the tablet knows where the stylus has been placed.

Active - An active model would have an actively powered stylus, i.e. both the tablet and the stylus are actively communicating to and forth. These are comparatively more responsive than passive tablets.

Passive - The passive model doesn't have any active electronics in the stylus, it merely acts as a device that bounces off whatever information that it receives. So the grid must act as both a transmitter and a receiver. In one instance the grid transmits the co-ordinates, this is temporarily stored in the stylus and then when the grid becomes a receiver it reads the information back from the stylus to know it's position. Since there is a rapid switching happening the tablet has to process information twice as fast to achieve the same capability of an active model.

Optical - These tablets have a miniature camera in the stylus which determines its current place on the tablet.

Acoustic - An acoustic model relies on creating a small spark between the stylus and the tablet, there are microphones positioned on the tablet which listen on

the intensity of the spark and figure out the proximity of the stylus to the mic. Two or more microphones can then be used to plot the position of the stylus with respect to the tablet.

Capacitive - These tablets have capacitive banks arranged in a grid like pattern across the surface, when a certain spot on the surface loses its charge due to contact with the stylus the screen detects the contact.



Size

Needless to say for an input device the size of the writing surface is a primary concern. Tablets come in a wide array of sizes and the bigger it gets the more expensive they tend to be. For tablets the size refers to the actual drawing area and does not include the bezels or the buttons that surround the tablet. The entry models come in sizes like 4"x5" and